MarkItDown Converter — User Manual

—— Your All-in-One File to Markdown Converter ——

Version V1.0 | Platform: Windows Desktop

Table of Contents

Table of Contents 1
1. Introduction 1
1.1 Overview 1
1.2 Supported Formats 2
2. Interface Overview 2
3. Quick Start 4
4. Feature Details 4
4.1 Adding Files 4
4.2 WeChat Files 4
4.3 Clearing the Queue 5
4.4 Setting the Output Directory 5
4.5 Reading the Terminal Log 5
4.6 Running the Conversion 5
4.7 Opening the Output Directory 5
5. Full Walkthrough Example 5
6. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) 6
Q1: Nothing happens after I drop a file into the queue? 6
Q2: The converted Markdown content is incomplete? 6
Q3: Where do I find the reason for a failed conversion? 6
Q4: How do I change where the converted files are saved? 6
Q5: The WeChat Files button cannot find the file I need? 6
Q6: What should I do if something goes wrong during installation? 6
7. Important Notes 7

1. Introduction

MarkItDown — Open Source from Microsoft on GitHub
Released under the MIT License

However, the original MarkItDown software has no graphical interface and is difficult to get started with — this software solves that problem.

1.1 Overview

MarkItDown Converter is a lightweight desktop utility whose core purpose is to convert everyday files — PDF, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, web pages, data files, images and audio — into Markdown text files with a single click.

Markdown is a plain-text markup language that is well-structured, easy to read, and ideal for searching and archiving. Once your files are converted to Markdown, they can be imported into knowledge bases, note-taking apps (such as Obsidian and Notion), large-language-model chat sessions, and version-control systems — making it the perfect intermediate format for organizing documents and managing knowledge.

The app offers an intuitive drag-and-drop interface. No command-line knowledge is required: drop your files into the window, click "Execute", and the job is done.

1.2 Supported Formats

The program currently supports the following input formats:

Category	Common Extensions	Conversion Notes
Document	.pdf	Extracts body text and paragraph structure into Markdown
Document	.docx / .doc	Extracts text, heading levels, lists and tables
Spreadsheet	.xlsx / .xls / .csv	Converts worksheet data into Markdown tables
Presentation	.pptx / .ppt	Extracts text content from each slide
Web page	.html / .htm	Strips tags and preserves the content structure
Data	.json / .xml	Converts structured data into readable text or code blocks
Image	.png / .jpg / .jpeg, etc.	Extracts text from images via OCR
Audio	.mp3 / .wav, etc.	Transcribes speech into text via speech recognition

Note: The conversion output is a standard .md (Markdown) text file, named after the original file and saved to the output directory you specify.

2. Interface Overview

The main window is divided into seven functional areas, laid out from top to bottom as shown below:

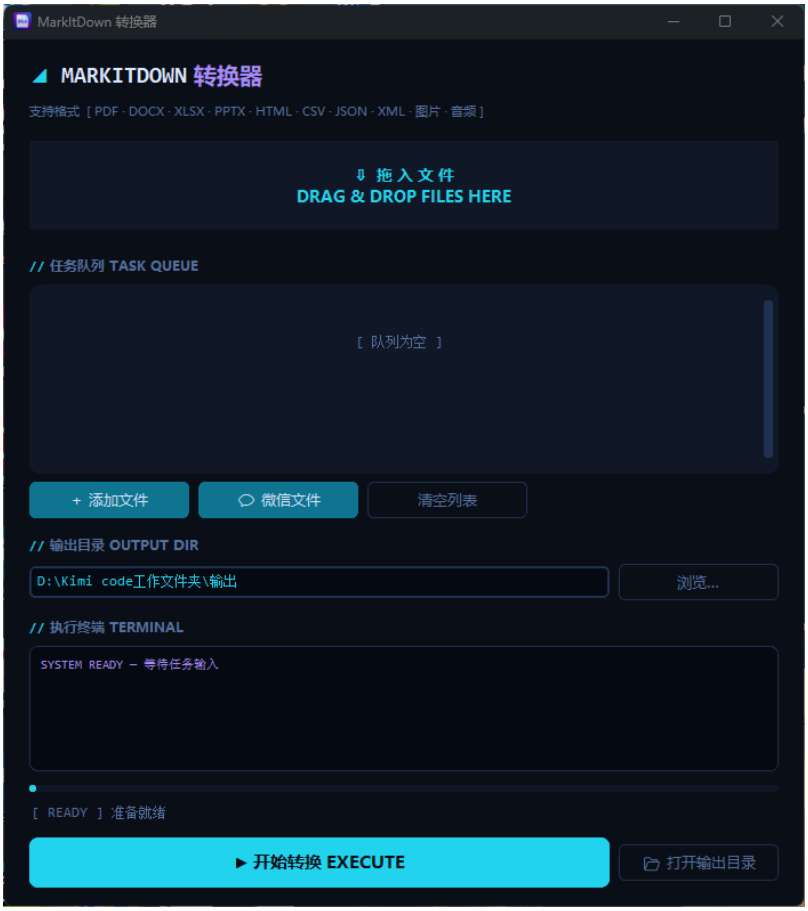


Figure 1 Main window of MarkItDown Converter

UI Area	Description
Title bar	Shows the app name "MarkItDown Converter" and the window controls (minimize, maximize, close)
Format hint bar	Lists the supported input formats: PDF, DOCX, XLSX, PPTX, HTML, CSV, JSON, XML, images and audio
Drop zone	The central dashed area — drag and drop files here to add them to the conversion queue
Task queue	Shows the list of files pending conversion; displays "Queue is empty" when no files are added
Action buttons	Three queue-management buttons: "Add Files", "WeChat Files" and "Clear List"

UI Area	Description
Output directory	Shows where the converted results are saved; change it via the "Browse..." button
Terminal log	Displays system status and conversion logs in real time for troubleshooting
Status bar	Shows the current status at the bottom left, e.g. "READY"
Execute buttons	"Execute" starts the conversion; "Open Output Dir" opens the results folder

3. Quick Start

Follow these five steps to go from adding files to viewing the results:

1. Set the output directory: confirm the path in the "OUTPUT DIR" field, or click "Browse..." to choose where the converted files will be saved.
2. Add files: drag files into the central drop zone, or click "Add Files" to pick them from your local disk. They will appear in the task queue.
3. Check the queue: verify the list of pending files in the task queue.
4. Run the conversion: click the "Execute" button at the bottom and watch the real-time log in the terminal area.
5. View the results: when finished, click "Open Output Dir" to inspect the generated .md files.

4. Feature Details

4.1 Adding Files

There are two ways to add files:

- Drag and drop: select one or more files in File Explorer, drag them into the dashed drop zone, and release the mouse button to add them to the queue.
- Button: click "＋ Add Files" and choose the files in the system file dialog.

Once added, files appear in the task queue. You may add multiple files repeatedly; the program converts them sequentially in queue order.

4.2 WeChat Files

Click the "WeChat Files" button to quickly locate and add files received in WeChat chats. The program scans WeChat's default file-receive folder (configurable in settings) and lists recently received documents — check the ones you need and they are added to the queue, saving you the trouble of digging through folders manually.

4.3 Clearing the Queue

Click "Clear List" to remove all files from the task queue. This only clears the pending list; it does not affect the result files already generated in the output directory. To remove a single file, click the delete icon on its queue entry.

4.4 Setting the Output Directory

The "OUTPUT DIR" field shows where the converted results are saved. Click the "Browse..." button on the right to pick a different folder in the directory picker. The program remembers the most recent path, so you do not need to set it again on the next launch.

4.5 Reading the Terminal Log

The "TERMINAL" area displays the program's log in real time, including system-ready status, per-file parsing progress, conversion results and error messages. After a normal startup the terminal shows "SYSTEM READY". If something goes wrong during conversion, the error message in the terminal will help you identify the cause.

4.6 Running the Conversion

After confirming the queue and the output directory, click the prominent "Execute" button at the bottom to start batch processing. Keep the program running and do not close the window during conversion. When all files are done, the status bar at the bottom left shows a completion message.

4.7 Opening the Output Directory

After the conversion finishes, click "Open Output Dir" at the bottom right. The system opens the output folder automatically so you can view, copy or further edit the generated Markdown files.

5. Full Walkthrough Example

The following example converts a PDF report to Markdown, demonstrating the complete workflow:

6. Launch MarkItDown Converter. The terminal shows "SYSTEM READY" and the status bar shows "READY".
7. Click "Browse..." and set the output directory to "D:\\kimi code 工作文件夹\\输出".

8. Select the PDF report in File Explorer and drag it into the drop zone; the file immediately appears as an entry in the task queue.
9. Click "Execute". The terminal starts scrolling parsing logs, showing the conversion progress of each file.
10. When finished, click "Open Output Dir" to see a .md file with the same name as the original. Open it in any text editor or Markdown reader to view the content.

Tip: When converting in batch, all files are processed in the order they were added; the terminal log keeps an individual record for each file for easy verification.

6. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q1: Nothing happens after I drop a file into the queue?

Make sure the file format is on the supported list (PDF, DOCX, XLSX, PPTX, HTML, CSV, JSON, XML, images, audio). If the file is locked by another program or corrupted, close the program that is using it and try again.

Q2: The converted Markdown content is incomplete?

For scanned PDFs and image-based documents, text-extraction quality depends on OCR accuracy, and complex layouts (multi-column pages, nested tables) may be slightly mis-structured. Always proofread the converted results.

Q3: Where do I find the reason for a failed conversion?

Check the error log in the "TERMINAL" area, which identifies the failed file and the cause. Common causes include: the file being locked by another program, file corruption, or an unsupported format.

Q4: How do I change where the converted files are saved?

Click "Browse..." next to the "OUTPUT DIR" field and pick a new folder. The program remembers the most recently used path.

Q5: The WeChat Files button cannot find the file I need?

Verify that the WeChat file-receive directory is set correctly and that the target file has been downloaded locally (files not downloaded in WeChat cannot be read).

Q6: What should I do if something goes wrong during installation?

If an error occurs during installation, the installation fails, or the program will not start after installation, please contact customer support first: right-click the program icon (the desktop shortcut or the Start-menu icon), choose "Open file location", find the installation log file in the installation directory (usually install.log or a file named "log"), and send that log file to customer support. Our engineers will use it to diagnose and resolve the issue.

7. Important Notes

- Before converting, make sure the source files are not locked by other programs (such as Word, Excel or Adobe Reader), otherwise the read may fail.
- Batch-converting a large number of big files (scanned PDFs, long audio recordings) takes time — please wait until the terminal log shows that everything is complete.
- For files involving privacy or confidentiality, manage the generated Markdown files in the output directory carefully to avoid information leaks.
- Markdown conversion preserves text content; visual styling of the original file (fonts, colors, precise layout) is not preserved.
- Update the program regularly for better format compatibility and recognition quality.
- If anything unusual happens during installation, right-click the program icon, choose "Open file location", and provide the installation log file from the installation directory to customer support for troubleshooting.